You Were Mine to Kill

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/36298540.

Rating:	Teen And Up Audiences
Archive Warning:	Major Character Death
Category:	F/F
Fandom:	She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)
Relationships:	Castaspella/Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Castaspella & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)
Characters:	Castaspella (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)
Additional Tags:	Calling this a "shipfic" is trolling my readers, Shippy if you Squint, Hurt No Comfort, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, I'm exploring SW's psychology, Shadow Weaver is in denial, She's also having a mental crisis, Adora always so merciful, Catra Leaves the Horde (She-Ra), Micah was never captured or sent to Beast Island, Mystacor is conquered instead of Salineas, This seriously hurts, Leave it to Shadow Weaver to be a possessive enemy, Suicidal Thoughts, Drunkenness, Heavy Angst, can't believe I had forgotten THE tag like that
Language:	English
Series:	Part 2 of Path 3, Part 2 of Cycles
Stats:	Published: 2022-01-17 Completed: 2022-01-19 Words: 6,385 Chapters: 3/3

You Were Mine to Kill

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Summary

The Sorcerers' Guild, its Head Sorceress, and her brother, the King of Bright Moon, have been a thorn on Shadow Weaver's side for years. All her plans have been frustrated by them every time, and Hordak grew angrier with each subsequent failure.

In one last desperate try, she suggested to him using the distraction of the Princess Alliance plan to siege Mystacor, instead of Salineas, which represented a greater advantage for the Horde. And it finally *worked*.

However, Shadow Weaver could have never foreseen the unexpected consequence of such conquer… or her own reaction to it.

Notes

Reading Frye7's Winx fanfic, *Lost*, I got reminded of this writing prompt saying "a very possessive villain is enraged because someone else killed their arch-nemesis instead of them and now seems to have lost their ambition", and I realized that could work like a charm in some sort of perhaps-shippy castaweaver, especially as their dynamic is basically that of Icy and Bloom Frye writes. So I **had** to take the chance to explore such a complex mentality; that's what I do, after all.
This will most likely be the only fic where I don't try to make SW grow a conscious or anything, because that's not the point here; no matter how much I like doing that, it simply doesn't fit with the kind of prompt I'm trying to fulfill.

Despite how much this will hurt, I hope you can enjoy it (I apologize to my C-a-S readers, I know I've already hurt you enough, I'm giving you the sequel soon! I promise!!)

Alright, that's it. ENJOY!

Edit: Confirmed! I'm writing **more** within with universe. Most specifically, not only what I mentioned in the very last note of the fic, I'll be writing a whole series of lives, about four of them. And I'm thinking about also writing the POV of Catra and Adora about SW's actions in each life so, heh, there's a lot to come

- Inspired by Lost by Frye7

The plan was "more than sucessful"

A dim red light illuminated the room; the Red Garnet submitted to Shadow Weaver's will once again. Hours ago, a full army had been dispatched by Hordak to siege Mystacor, and the dark sorceress awaited the result impatiently; if another one of her plans failed, Hordak wouldn't have mercy, especially after she had convinced him to use Double Trouble's distraction to take the floating kingdom instead of Salineas, as he intended. But wasn't she right? If they took Mystacor, they would have an important advantage to plan future conquests, while also getting rid of the Sorcerers' Guild that kept defeating her every individual plan.

She felt such hatred for the Guild. Micah was sufficiently powerful to counter her magic, but she knew him well enough to outsmart him, that had never been a problem; the nuisance was his sister, the Head Sorceress, whom she didn't know at all. Her spellcasting was *so* sloppy… That only made her all the more furious as Castaspella managed to defeat her time and again. She was so *persistent,* and somehow always managed to "save everyone"; it was frustrating being unable to, at least, take them down one by one. And her last attempt to face the whole Guild had been…

—Ahg!

She angrily slammed her claws against the Black Garnet, as if wanting to sink them into the hard crystal, and red electricity immediately crackled from the runestone into her. She *loathed* thinking about that defeat. If Mystacor fell, it would certainly be the ideal revenge, one that could put her in Hordak's good graces while simultaneously allowing her to get as far as possible from him and the majority of the cadets; only the supplies, the strategists, and her runestone; all by taking Castaspella's *precious* kingdom. It was a *perfect* plan.

The sound of heavy steps approached and the sorceress looked back in anticipation; a soldier arrived, saying —Excuse me, Shadow Weaver.

—Do you bring news about Mystacor's fall? If not, I don't want to hear it.

—Certainly, I do— he assured her. —With the Princesses and She-Ra distracted, we managed to successfully carry out the mission, as instructed by Hordak. In fact, it was more than successful.

She froze. What could that mean? The white sockets of her mask narrowed in suspicion, yet she preferred to keep up appearances and remain as casual as possible.

—How exactly was it "more than successful"?

The soldier cleared his throat and explained —Not only have we taken control of Mystacor; we also managed to take down the Head Sorceress and the Sorcerers' Guild has crumbled. Mystacor is completely ours.

Now that sounded like good news. The roles had been reversed: she had won, that sorceress was defeated. Shadow Weaver smirked in anticipation, she couldn't wait to see her expression of defeat.

—Perfect then— she finally let out, much to the trembling soldier's relief. —With the *former* Head Sorceress as our prisoner, there will be no stopping my plans— she gloated, placing a hand on the Black Garnet, already fantasizing about the power it would let her unleash without magical resistance from the Rebellion.

—I-in fact…— the soldier interrupted, visibly displeasing the sorceress, who looked back at him, annoyed, making the runestone glow under her touch. —Pardon me, but… The Head Sorceress *isn't* our prisoner— he clarified.

—So she escaped?

The mask wouldn't let him see it, but the moment the soldier shook his head, the woman lost her breath for a moment; she was so stunned one would have thought she had just seen a ghost. However, the soldier could only see the expressionless mask and tendrils of electricity erratically flickering around her hand, so he felt the need to quickly correct his mistake or face her fury.

—Y-you could say she has been slain— he finally said.

Slain… as in, *killed*?

—Explain yourself, cadet— she harshly ordered, expecting him to be confusing terms.

—Well, I mean…— he stammered a bit, then cleared his throat. —We didn't exactly kill her. It was her magic— he managed to say. The sorceress stayed silent as her mind went blank; there was no way that was true, *it couldn't be true*. The soldier decided to explain more of what had happened, fearing her increasing rage. —She tried to protect everyone, sent her people away, and held a shield spell on her own until she exhausted herself. So, it must have been her own magic that killed her. But we made sure; she *is* dead— he explained. Shadow Weaver no longer listened as he went on —Yet her sacrifice couldn't stop us. We quickly took over Mystacor, and even the King of Bright Moon is our prisoner now.

The Black Garnet suddenly flashed brightly, a booming sound came out along with lightning arcs that shot up and down, as the woman yelled —Enough!

The soldier recognized sheer wrath in her voice and the runestone's sudden reaction, so he hesitantly asked —Is a-anything displeasing you, Shadow Weaver?

What could she *possibly* reply? She didn't know the answer herself. Not like it mattered to her. Now she had plans to set into motion; she couldn't care less for what was upsetting her.

—Your bragging is insufferable— she retorted, threateningly. —Make yourself useful and have all strategists prepare themselves to move into the island. Procure all supplies and equipment are ready to be taken into Mystacor in an hour— she ordered. —And only when everything is settled, bring the strongest to handle the runestone's relocation.

The soldier saluted and quickly left to carry out her orders. The sorceress, however, felt breathless again. She simply could *not* understand the pressure on her chest.

Her nemesis was dead, she *should* be glad.

But she *wasn't* the one who killed her.

No, the idiot had drained her own lifeforce! And she hadn't even *been* there; it wasn't *her* who pushed Castaspella to her limit, it had been Hordak's pathetic troops! How dare they take *her* enemy!? The sorceress was *hers*! She was the one supposed to cause her demise!

The woman let out a roaring cry, both hands grasping the Black Garnet harder than ever, and dark red energy enveloped her, overloading her senses to the point she felt drunk with power.

That was it.

Castaspella was dead.

She could now do her will, no one would impede her now.

That's what she wanted, *wasn't it*?

During the next hour, the sorceress remained hidden within shadows, listening as Hordak ordered the head strategists to use their new advantageous position to prepare the attack on Salineas as soon as possible. Shadow Weaver wanted to supervise the move out to keep herself occupied, but every time she saw Hordak she felt raging wrath she couldn't explain nor wanted to; she just needed to leave as soon as possible and avoid him in the meantime, or she would completely lose control.

The time finally came and she didn't waste a second; there was nothing else for her in the Fright Zone, and she'd rather never return either. When Shadow Weaver finally arrived at Mystacor, Horde banners had been hung everywhere, and the soldiers, the cadets who helped with the move, and the settled strategist, were all over the place, partying, already drinking and eating the provisions the Guild had stored; they hadn't achieved such a victory in a very long time, no one could deny them a little party. Besides, they received her with a chalice of wine and the promise to constantly refill it.

Aside from being exactly what she needed, it could also be the perfect solution to the annoying noise in her head, to numb that damned pressure on her chest and drown her unreasonable anger. So she followed a few soldiers into one of the buildings upstairs, and sat a few hours to drink cup after cup.

Shadow Weaver managed to forget about everything in the world. Even her *precious* runestone slipped her mind, and she never checked in what condition it had arrived. However, with the rise of the moons, her clarity returned. Her first instinct was to drink more, and yet, when she took the bottle, her drunkness began playing tricks on her mind. She saw

herself reflected in the bottle; not the mask, her old face… She knew Light Spinner was long gone, she wasn't that person anymore but, being so drunk, memories she had banished returned.

Micah. He was now a prisoner, no? So he was probably being held in one of the storage rooms, according to what she had overheard. It was a curious idea: *Sweet talented Micah* was finally defeated. Never thought the day would come… Oh, but *poor sweet Micah*, was he even aware of what happened to his sister? She's well aware of how much he loved her, it was easy to guess she was his weak spot.

Her thoughts kept repeating those ideas; they spiraled out of her control until her poor criteria let her grab some food and take it to the sorcerer. Soon, she was approaching the storeroom where he had been imprisoned; he sat alone, a pair of handcuffs kept his hands together, impeding his casting, and the look of resignation in his face was enough for Shadow Weaver to realize, even in her state, that he knew of Castaspella's death.

She was merely a few steps into de room when he looked up, immediately furious as he saw her, and barked —How *dare* you to show up here!? You *monster*! How could you!? I will annihilate you! That's a promise!

His eyes were red, both from his current fury and having cried recently. He looked so devastated, his threat was one last desperate cry. New tears fell down his cheeks as he glared at her with murderous eyes. Micah could really kill her if he were freed right then and there. But the woman was perhaps too drunk to care at all. She carelessly approached, placed the food she brought him within his reach, walked back to the wall in front of him, and laid back, starting to feel dizzy.

—Stop shouting, Micah— she finally said. It was obvious from her voice how far from sober she was, and he only stared at her with rage. —Eat. They won't feed you real food anymore, just… those disgusting rations— she told him, dragging the words a bit.

—What are you doing here!?— he questioned her, refusing to eat. The woman only stared back in silence, seemingly too slow to react. —Shouldn't you be up there in your party, gloating about how you *killed my sister*!?— he yelled, finally getting a reaction from her.

Shadow Weaver pushed herself off the wall and stumbled forward uttering —That was *not* my plan. Not at all…

—It doesn't matter!— he interrupted her. —You *hate* us!

—Do *not* presume to know what I feel!— she immediately lashed out, shocking Micah. He stared at her, too stunned to speak, and noticed how she struggled to keep herself up and turned back around clumsily, yet still added —I never… never hated you… either of you—. She had to make a great effort to speak, and continued with a weak tone —I thought she… They *had* to take her prisoner. Prisoner like you. But… those *fools* pushed her to the limit! She let her… her power kill her… so stubborn… The idiot was stubborn enough to… to sacrifice herself protecting you all… *And for what*! Your precious little guild feel! Her death… it meant *nothing*!

Her voice was unmistakenly loaded with rage, especially at the end, which further confused Micah.

He shook his head and asked, skeptical, —What do you care?

Shadow Weaver straightened her back, rising to her full height while turning around to face him. Right after, she reached for her mask and tore it off her face, immediately throwing it away.

—You know *nothing*!— she roared at him.

Right after, she retreated and stormed off, forgetting her mask there, and left Micah alone once again.

He couldn't understand why she would be enraged by Castaspella's death. Didn't she want her dead? Hadn't she warned her, several times, one day she'd be her downfall? Weren't they sworn enemies? What had that outburst been?

The King forced himself to stop dwelling on all of that. Whatever her reasons were, he didn't care. He couldn't care less about what she thought or felt. His eyes filled with tears again and he sobbed quietly, finally succumbing to hunger and eating what the drunk sorceress had left for him.

—I'll get out of here— he muttered to himself. —And I'll take Mystacor back for you, Sis.

She was too attentive for her own good

Chapter Notes

> I suppose I wrote a pretty badass Casta here but, honestly, the 80s Casta was, in fact, impressive; the reboot version was seriously nerfed… ANYWAYS, I hope you enjoy

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The sky had already darkened and there was a cold night breeze blowing through Mystacor. Shadow Weaver kept going higher into the buildings of the island, too drunk to even think about where she was going. She only stopped her furious walking when a red light inside a room called her attention.

It was the Black Garnet, settled in the middle of an empty fancy chamber. Perfect; might as well focus on her experimentation with the runestone and ignore everything else.

She locked herself inside and had to rest the first few hours until she felt sober again, however, even then she struggled for hours without results. She hadn't slept and probably had no idea it was already the afternoon; Shadow Weaver was consumed by thoughts she desperately wanted to ignore, but the frustration of the Black Garnet's defiance only made those thoughts stronger.

The Head Sorceress was *dead*.

She let her magic sip her life out, *trying to protect everyone*.

The sacrifice was *futile*, she did it *for nothing*.

Now, she'd have *no chance* to prove herself better than Castaspella.

She wanted to see her expression of defeat, but *now couldn't*.

She'd *never know* what it would be like to have her as a prisoner, what her reaction to losing would be.

All the reactions she had fantasized with so many times, all the things Castaspella had made her feel after each defeat, now she'd never have a chance to see those in the sorceress, her enemy. This couldn't be undone now, no power in the whole universe could bring her back. She had lost so many chances.

—Agh!

With a deafening roar, Shadow Weaver struck her claws against the Black Garnet, but the electricity just cackled erratically around it and never provided her an ounce of power. She

just couldn't get it. The runestone resisted her more than ever before.

As she felt a headache brewing, she moved a hand up to her forehead, only then realizing she didn't have her mask on. Without the assistance of the gem it has, it wouldn't be easy to get the Black Garnet's power. Yet she absolutely refused to go back for it and see Micah again.

No, she would just use her old sorcery knowledge to hack into the runestone. She could do it, she *had* to do it. Besides, it was much better to keep herself busy with something, even by making it purposely more difficult; she refused to address her annoying thoughts: lost opportunities because of her death, stupid things that she didn't need.

But perhaps she wanted them.

She shook her head and her jaw tensed, as if trying to intimidate and force back those thoughts. Shadow Weaver couldn't let them take over her like that, and now she had to concentrate to properly cast as she used to. Her sorcery was just as perfect as usual but her head was too troubled, which she wouldn't admit, so every spell had a minimal flaw that made them fail, and each try frustrated her even more.

The woman yelled loudly once again and began throwing spells like crazy, even if she knew brute force hadn't worked before; she wasn't thinking anymore, blinded by rage and with nothing stopping her, she shot spell after spell until she passed out of exhaustion.

The Black Garnet hummed, its red light waned a bit, and its low murmur filled the chamber while Shadow Weaver was deep asleep.

Memories haunted her dreams; the times Castaspella had defeated her, the times she thought she had out-smarted the Head Sorceress only to discover she had walked right into her trap, the times she had Micah at her mercy but never managed to get anything from him because his sister would dashingly save him before she noticed… And then, that time she tried to face the whole Guild, and was captured, solely because she stopped everyone who intended to kill her.

She could remember being thrown in a cellar afterwards, and absolutely resenting that she spared her; before that, she would have preferred death. There were guards in the door who wouldn't answer her, no one gave her food or drink, or cared if the place got colder than bearable.

Except for her.

Castaspella was too attentive for her own good. She wouldn't let her go hungry, insisted she had to be given water every few hours at least, and every time she went to interrogate her, before leaving she'd ask her about the room temperature and whether she needed anything. *Why* would she be that nice to her?

It wasn't even an exchange system or anything; the Head Sorceress had procured her all basic needs and even offered more, despite Shadow Weaver never having uttered a word. And if

that wasn’t enough, she’d even mock the sorceress instead of answering her questions.

She had given Castaspella no reasons to treat her the least bit respectfully, and plenty of reasons to justify even torture. And yet, if that wasn’t disgruntling already, the moment Shadow Weaver had managed to escape, she noticed the Head Sorceress saw her soon enough to recapture her, but she didn’t; she even stopped the acolyte who rushed to try and catch her.

With that, the woman woke up suddenly, finding herself on the floor, meters away from the Black Garnet, its light weaker than ever. That last memory had kept her disturbed for weeks when it happened, trying to understand why she had done that, what kind of manipulation it was. And now she was once again unsettled by such behaviour; she had waited for an opportunity to be the one interrogating her, to get answers and finally let the matter go. Now it wouldn’t ever be answered, she’d be haunted by the unexplainable, which would likely affect her powers again.

The thought enraged her and the Black Garnet seemed to answer to her rage, but it wasn’t under her control at all. The lightning arcs were more violent and numerous than ever, hitting the walls, leaving dark burn marks, and soon, even her black magic began leaking out of it, as if the runestone was purging itself. From the outside, it could be seen by the Horde recruits; they were curious about the black tendrils trying to leave the chamber and the red flashes that accompanied, but no one would dare step any closer.

—Is this… Normal?— a rather new recruit asked, staring at the entrance of the locked room from a safe distance.

The closest soldier immediately answered —Not like this…

—This seems… More dangerous— another one commented.

—In any case, we shan’t approach the chamber— a force captain ordered. —And we better keep everyone away too. If that… *thing* hurts any of you, no one will help you.

With that last warning, everyone made sure to block the way to the entire corridor, lest someone accidentally wandered near the room.

Another two days went by, and Shadow Weaver never left the room. The Horde strategists didn't need the sorceress for their planning, so they had already schemed the siege of Salineas, which should already be starting. Furthermore, despite informing Hordak that the woman hadn't been seen since her arrival, he didn't give it importance at all so no one had reasons to approach the chamber. For all they cared, the sorceress could well be dead and it wouldn't change their plans in the slightest.

In mere hours, the first battle reports were in, and the strategists soon realized there was a variant they hadn't considered: all the princesses were at the Seagate, fighting the Horde forces, but neither She-Ra nor Catra were accounted for. However, they had no time to warn the few soldiers on the island before some of Bright Moon’s forces arrived at Mystacor, led

by both of them, clearly intending to recover the floating kingdom now that almost all forces were in Salineas.

Chaos broke out; the Horde didn't have nearly enough manpower to repel them, and while the soldiers of Bright Moon kept them all busy, She-Ra and Catra rushed to free the prisoners. As soon as they had taken them to safety, they decided to check the rest of Mystacor while the battle between Horde and Bright Moon forces dragged on.

When they arrived at the closed corridor, they could almost immediately realize Shadow Weaver had to be there.

—What do you say?— She-Ra asked.

—If she's in there… We should go for her— Catra replied. —This was… What happened here is inexcusable. If she hasn't escaped yet, we should take her prisoner, have her answer for all of this.

—I suppose; but you know what happened last time.

—We can handle this, Adora.

They confidently approached the chamber, and She-Ra kicked the door open. The first thing they noticed was the burnt walls and scorched floor; the room was a wreck, and right in the middle, the Black Garner seemed the source of such destruction, yet it was now completely dull.

She-Ra took a step towards the runestone, curious, but Catra held her wrist and shifted her attention to the wall on their left. Between the darkness and the black ash covering almost everything, it was difficult to notice Shadow Weaver, sitting on the floor and leaning against the wall. The woman was too still, but they approached carefully regardless.

They soon noticed she didn't have her mask on; they could clearly see her face, and hers was the expression of defeat. She had given up. It took them a moment to process what they were seeing; they had never imagined they would ever witness such a scene.

Shadow Weaver barely raised her sight a bit, noticing Catra and She-Ra approaching. A bitter smirk appeared on her face; it was finally time. With *her* gone, no one would stop the execution. And she didn't want to be shown any mercy either.

—Shadow Weaver— She-Ra called out, pointing at her with the sword. —We are retaking Mystacor; we've freed all prisoners and the Horde forces will soon be completely defeated. Don't try anything or we'll end you too.

—Do it— the sorceress uttered. She-Ra and Catra exchanged a confused glance. They looked at her again, suspicious, intending to discover the manipulation behind her words. But she only added —Go ahead. Now *no one* can stop you from delivering the killing blow.

She-Ra hesitated a moment. The tone, the lack of energy in her expression and voice, and that specific wording…

—You're talking about… the Head Sorceress?— she asked, perplexed. —Didn't *you* kill her?

—I did not! That was *not* part of the plan!— the woman suddenly shouted, enraged; her eyes seemed to have recovered some of their life. A new fire was lit with her wrath, but it soon flickered and waned. —That wasn't…— she trailed off, her sight on the ground. A moment later, she looked up to them again and yelled —Just kill me already!

Once again, the girls exchanged a look of understanding. There were no doubts: now that Castaspella is dead, she wants to die too.

—Why would you care about the Head Sorceress?— Catra decided to ask, finding this completely illogical. —Wasn't she your nemesis? Didn't you wanna kill her!?

—Only *I* could kill her!— she immediately reacted, yelling madly again, before falling back against the wall. —Or spare her…— she continued, with a weaker tone and her sigh unfocused. —Like she spared me.

So that was it. She-Ra turned back into Adora and looked at Catra with utmost surprise; they were both astonished as they hadn’t ever seen *her* like that, and couldn’t have imagined anything would ever affect her this much. They silently waited for her to say something else, but she only kept her sight fixed on the floor, didn’t move a muscle, almost as if she had died, which made them feel far more anguished than they would have expected.

Chapter End Notes

This cliff-hanger wasn't intentional… you guys were just unlucky enough that the extra 500 words in this part came right before that last paragraph (._.")

(u^u) And I may or may not have something else in store… but lets first see how this does, and then I *may* consider posting that something else…

You ruined my mind at the speed of light...

Chapter Notes

Ready?

I doubt it

See the end of the chapter for more notes

—Sha-Shadow Weaver?— Catra asked with a shaky voice.

The woman took a deep breath and let out a sigh, which relieved both girls a bit, then began talking, absentmindedly, —I was *so* eager to have her as prisoner—, a bitter laugh interrupted her speech briefly, —She had treated me too well when I was her prisoner. I was at her mercy yet she behaved… respectfully, even caring. *Who* does that!?—. She breathed out a long sigh, deflated, and the girls kept quiet once again, waiting for her to continue. —I don't even know how I would have treated her. Perhaps I wanted to see if there was any reason to be *nice* at her… or whatever I could manage. I don't do *nice*.

Catra scoffed and rolled her eyes, agreeing —Yeah, that's for sure.

However, Adora is so confused she asks —If you didn't hate her… why were you so eager to kill her yourself, while you're now so… upset about her death?

—Obsession? A twisted desire to be the only focus of her?— she replied, looking away, with obvious self-contempt. —I just can't… stand it now. I *wanted* to kill her, to be the one who…— she admitted, then trailed off. Her tone changed to a more ashamed one as she reflected —But perhaps I would feel the same too. What *am I* even feeling!? You both know full well I do not care…

Adora and Catra exchanged a look of agreement, reassuring and encouraging each other for what they were about to say.

—And yet… you raised us. Taught us.

—To be weapons, obedient soldiers, tools— Shadow Weaver immediately countered.

—You could do that without even feeding us, or teaching us to get dressed, read, write— Catra pointed out, mildly annoyed at her stubbornness. —You tortured me, shouted at me, I *know* you hated me. But you didn't dispose of me like you threatened.

—Because Adora has always been fond of you.

—All the more reasons to get rid of me as soon as possible! Or to make her hate me!— she insisted. She took a deep breath, calming herself again, and continued, —But you didn't even put us against each other. You had us as *partners*, and roommates.

—Don't confuse strategy with leniency— the woman refuted with a scowl.

—Any strategy can also be lenient— Adora pressed on. —You may have been cruel, denied having a heart. But, like it or not, you have emotions. And refusing to acknowledge feelings, no matter how small or selfish, doesn't mean you don't feel them.

—Just strike me down already and end this pitiful spectacle. Not like you don't hate me either — she interrupted, refusing to hear any more of it.

She couldn't bear it; the regret, the emotions and feelings, the memories, the conflict. She did *not* want to deal with any of it.

—Are you *insane*!?— Catra yelled, extracting her out of the spiral of thoughts. Indignant, she went on, irritation straining her voice, —We aren't monsters like you! And if you didn't kill us, why would we either!? Are you *so much* of an idiot that you can't see we…

Catra interrupted herself, breathing heavily, not knowing how to finish. Adora noticed her hesitation and preferred to continue herself.

She put a hand on Catra's shoulder to calm her down again, and spoke —You are a cruel woman, and nothing in the world can change that. But you raised us, I want- *we* want to believe there is *some* good inside you, perhaps too deep down, but still there. We wouldn't ever end you… or let anyone, including yourself, kill you.

Adora and Catra finally convinced Shadow Weaver of following them outside; the woman had surrendered so they wouldn't leave her there for someone else to find and kill her as she wished. However, they soon came across Micah, whom they had released earlier.

—You!— he immediately yelled, charging at her. Catra stopped him and Adora got between them, much to Shadow Weaver's annoyance. —Let me go! I *will* kill her!

—No you won't!— Catra retorted. —We won't let you!

—King Micah, don't do this! It was not her fault— Adora clarified.

—Yes it was; I gave Hordak the idea of taking Mystacor first— the sorceress countered, wanting to provoke Micah so he'll just blast her.

—Shut up, bitch!— Catra yelled at her. —Sorry, King Micah, but you can't kill her— she insisted with a severe tone yet trying not to yell again.

—My sister is *dead*! I want her dead too! Last I saw Casta, she was giving her life *for us*! And now she's probably in some… wherever your damned Horde soldiers threw her!— he sobbed.

Shadow Weaver's eyes widened. What had he just said? She hadn't heard a word about the sorceress' body, or seen it either, now that she thought about it. Where was she? If none of Bright Moon's soldiers had found her yet…

—I was only told she was dead, and that you had been imprisoned— the woman replied calmly. —When I arrived here, she was nowhere to be found; wherever she fell, she had already been removed, yet none of the soldiers said a thing about having taken her body somewhere.

—Then find her— Adora exhorted her. —We know you can do that with your magic, and King Micah deserves being able to give her a proper burial to mourn her.

—I thought you'd take me as a prisoner.

—First, find her, then we're gonna take you to Bright Moon as our prisoner— Catra retorted. Right after, she looked back at Micah and said —I will release you now… *Don't* attack her.

Shadow Weaver seemed confused for a moment, until she finally realized —I suppose I *could* try with the pulse spell… but there's no evidence of it working with someone who is dead. I'll attempt it, regardless.

Perhaps, upon seeing her body, Micah would finally kill her before the girls could stop him.

Adora and Catra walked them all the way up to the Lunarium, making sure the sorcerer wouldn't attack Shadow Weaver, nor would she provoke him to do so. When they arrived, the three of them were almost expecting the woman to try and escape, use a spell to end herself, or taunt the king again.

Yet she didn't. She actually used the pulse and the four of them gathered around her to see what her scrying showed. It looked like the Whispering Woods; she was sprawled on the floor, motionless, her crown laying nearby, with plenty of branches and leaves surrounding her. The sorceress instantly realized that, for how long it had been since her death, her state wasn't the expected one. However, between the effect of her own sorcery on her and the dry, cold, and magically infused environment of the woods, it made sense.

—Where is that?— Micah asked, his voice already broken and tears falling down his cheeks.

—We can't know for sure, but— Shadow Weaver began, yet interrupted herself a moment as she observed her a bit closer. —Those branches… The cuts in her skin and clothes suggest the trees harmed her; meaning she fell *through* them— she explained. The four of them looked up, shocked, before she severely concluded —They threw her from the edge of the island, the trees eased her fall.

—Those *beasts*!

Micah yelled exactly what they all were thinking; even with their animosity, Shadow Weaver wouldn't disrespect the dead like that.

It wasn’t long before they were all walking through the woods, right under Mystacor, following the sorceress. She had produced something that could guide them to where the pulse spell had shown, and convinced them only *she* could keep it active. It was a blatant lie but, fortunately, Micah didn’t know enough to realize that; she couldn’t help thinking that Castaspella, on the other hand, would have called out her lie in a heartbeat.

She insisted they *had* to take her with them to find the woman, perhaps because part of her still couldn't believe the Head Sorceress had died. She needed to see her one last time, extract Castaspella from her mind, and get rid of these stupid feelings and thoughts that annoyed her so much.

Once again, she was falling into a spiral of questions: why was she feeling so anxious to the point her heart felt about to burst? Why did it feel like a *need* to see her? To make sure she’s dead? Did she *really* want her to be dead? And what exactly would she do once they found her? Farewell? Was there any point in doing so? Part of her really wanted to for reasons that completely escaped her comprehension. How could this worry her *so much*? Since when did she care about someone’s death? And the urge for a last goodbye? It felt so *wrong* but she *wanted* it.

Perhaps it was just to relish in seeing her greatest competence gone. She wouldn’t say it aloud, but she deeply envied her; what made Castaspella *so* special for her to begrudge her? It couldn’t be her night-black hair, they both had it and hers looked better than the Head Sorceress', no? What a stupid thought. Perhaps the fact that she could show her eyes, as they were still intact and beautiful, while hers had deformed and now looked monstrous. Absolutely no, why would she care about such insignificant matters!? Could well be that she could easily match her pace, even outsmart her, without requiring the help of dark magic; or that the sorceress had been right in every reproach she ever made her.

When she said losing Micah and now being hated by him was her fault and hers alone; when she said no one pushed her to join Hordak but rather she chose it herself; when she reminded her she could easily leave the Horde whenever she wanted and that staying was *also* her choice; or when she said it was never too late for anyone to change, including her…

No, she was a fool! All of those things she kept thinking, it was all Castaspella’s naïve ideas that were now messing with her head. She didn’t think like that at all; she *couldn’t* think like that, right?

It was all so stupid! Why would *she*, Shadow Weaver, covet anything from the Head Sorceress? She didn’t care for those things, did she? And how could she think any of her annoying reproaches or innocent prompts hold any truth? No, not at all; there was no hope for her, there was no turning back, there was either triumph or death. And now that she wouldn’t ever achieve victory over her, there was only one option.

Soon enough, Shadow Weaver moved aside some tall coppices and stepped right into the place they had observed before. Adora, Catra, and Micah crossed the bushes and froze upon

seeing Castaspella laying a few meters in front of them. The King fell on his knees right where he was as all his strength vanished, and the girls reacted immediately, wanting to support him.

But the sorceress slowly approached the corpse, her mind blank, and the worst pressing feeling on her chest, as she had never experienced before. The second she reached Castaspella, Shadow Weaver immediately cast darkness around them both, keeping Micah, Adora, and Catra away with her dark magic, not even letting them see.

She looked back at the Head Sorceress, collapsed to the ground with her fists tightly closed, and angrily let out —You and your idiotic righteousness… Why couldn't you, *this once*, be more selfish!?—. She let out something between a sigh and a growl, enraged at herself, at Castaspella, at the soldiers, even at Micah for not helping her. —Who gave you the *right*? How dare you mess with me this way?— she selfishly asked, gradually bending over her; she was right by the sorceress' head, observing her lifeless expression. —You just did it, Castaspella. You ruined my mind at the speed of light… Somehow, even after death, you still managed to subdue my shadows. I couldn't prove myself better than you, and now I believe that wouldn't have happened even if we both died of old age. I hate and admire that you were, in fact, *better* than me— she admitted.

Finally, she dared reach out and cupped her face, placing her palm under the sorceress' chin. Castaspella's skin was cold, felt rough with soil, had several bruises covering her skin, and those cuts the branches left on her were all dry and dirty. However, there was also a particular scar on the left side of her jaw. Shadow Weaver noticed it was old, looked like a pale line, and it coincidentally had the size of the claw she was now brushing over it. She tried to remember if she did it but, instantly, hazy memories made her head hurt.

It shook her senses enough to hear Micah threatening —I'll tear this spell down and kill you!

Realizing she had little time left, she ignored those memories and concluded her farewell, nearing Castaspella's face, whispering as if the woman could still hear her —I shall join you in the afterlife soon, and we'll continue with our skirmishes— she vowed, right before planting a kiss on her forehead.

Shadow Weaver withdrew from her the exact moment Micah managed to break her spell; she stood where she was but rose her hands in surrender.

—Get away from her!— he yelled, stalking at her menacingly.

—Go ahead, Micah! Fulfill your promise!— she taunted.

The sorcerer immediately cast a spell to keep Catra and Adora from reaching them, looked back at Shadow Weaver, snarling, and directed his staff at her chest, the tip glowing with a spell ready to fire…

Chapter End Notes

And that's all for this little angst (more like mega angst but this whole thing is pretty short)

So… That last paragraph mentioned these "hazy memories", and the scar… Well, there *is* history behind those; one that SW can't remember. But I guess, if someone of you guys want it, I *could* write and post that ("^_^)

Regardless, I hope you guys liked this little experiment and, once again, Frye, a huge thank you for inspiring me this much, I really hope you like what I did.

If you want to go scream at me for this, or nag me for updates of Path 1, or even extract spoilers from me -totally doable because I *love* talking about the stuff I will be posting, heh, you can drop by my twitter. Now bye!!

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